

What Factors Drive High IMDB Ratings and Box Office Revenue?

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Movies have always been a big deal not just as entertainment, but as a massive global industry. IMDB, the world's largest movie database, gets over 250 million visitors every month and has ratings from more than 1.3 billion users. Before COVID-19 hit, the film industry was pulling in around \$26 billion USD every year at the box office alone.

So what actually makes a movie successful? That's the question we set out to answer. Success in film isn't straightforward a movie can win critical praise but flop at the box office, or become a blockbuster hit without a single award. We looked at success from two angles: how audiences and critics rate a film (using IMDB ratings and Metascores), and how much money it actually makes (box office revenue).

There are plenty of theories about what drives a movie's success its genre, how long it runs, its age certificate, who directed it, or even the decade it was released in. But surprisingly, there hasn't been much data-driven work that pulls all of this together.

That's exactly what this report does. We used the IMDB Top 1000 Movies dataset from Kaggle covering the 1000 highest-rated films from the 1920s all the way to the 2020s to find out which factors actually matter. Using R for our analysis, we looked at genre, runtime,

release decade, Metascore, number of votes, and gross revenue to spot patterns in what makes films succeed.

Our goal is simple give filmmakers and studios useful, evidence-based insights to help them make better decisions.